

Istanbul Bariatric Center NEWSLETTER

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Drinking Proteins



You will need to drink protein shakes for the first days and weeks after your surgery, since getting enough protein from solid foods may be very hard.

However, you should also start eating pureed foods early on, since they will help you transition to a long-term healthy eating plan. Choose high-quality protein sources, such as whey protein isolate, soy protein isolate, or egg white powder. You can also drink milk between meals for extra protein.

Focus on eating only protein-rich foods at first, since you can only eat small amounts. Eating whole foods also burns more calories than drinking liquids. Try some pureed turkey chili for a change!

Here are some tips for choosing bariatric-friendly protein powders:

Pick whey protein isolate. It has the highest amount of essential amino acids and is easy for your body to absorb. Some good brands are biPro and UNJURY. Other options: You can also try soy protein isolate (vegan) or egg white powder. They are also high in protein and low in calories. **Go for unflavored versions.** They have no artificial ingredients and are sugar-free.

If you want some flavor: Look for products that are sweetened with stevia, sucralose (Splenda), or other sugar substitutes.

They have zero calories and won't cause dumping syndrome. There are many flavors to choose from, such as vanilla or butter pecan. Avoid sugar alcohols (erythritol, mannitol, xylitol, and sorbitol), as they have some calories and can upset your stomach.



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Carbohydrates

Carbohydrates are important for your body, as they provide energy for your brain and other functions. You will eat very little or no carbs in the first phase of your post-operative diet. Your body will use fat and protein for energy instead. Carbohydrates come in two types: simple or complex. Simple carbohydrates are quickly digested and turn into sugar in your blood, giving you a short burst of energy and then a crash.

Simple carbs include foods made with white flour, candy, soda, juice drinks, and many processed foods. Complex carbohydrates are digested more slowly and are rich in fiber, vitamins, and minerals.

They include 100 percent whole-grain foods, fruits, and vegetables. You should limit simple carbs and eat more complex carbs.

What to Eat:

Fresh fruits, vegetables, sweet potatoes or white potatoes with skin, oatmeal, 100 percent whole-grain products (toasted ones are easier to digest than soft ones), brown or wild rice or 100 percent whole-wheat pasta (if you can tolerate them), barley and ancient grains (quinoa, spelt, farrow, and millet)

Amount per Day: very little at first; after the first year and long term, aim for no more than 35 to 45 percent of total calories from carbohydrates

What to Limit or Avoid: any white refined grain products (white bread, white pasta, and crackers), cookies, candies, cakes, pastries, juices (including fruit juice), sodas, and chips



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A NOTE ABOUT SUGAR

Sugar is not good for you after surgery. It can cause **dumping syndrome**, which is a condition that happens when you eat foods high in sugar or too many carbs at once.

You may feel shaky, lightheaded, sweaty, or dizzy (you may even faint), your heart rate may increase, your blood sugar may drop (reactive hypoglycemia), you may have stomach cramps, and diarrhea. Dumping syndrome is more common in people who have had the Roux-en-Y gastric bypass or BPD/DS surgery.

You may also get dumping syndrome if you have had the sleeve gastrectomy surgery. This is a side effect that happens when you eat too much sugar or carbs at once. You may feel sick, dizzy, sweaty, or shaky (you may even pass out), your heart rate may go up, your blood sugar may go down (reactive hypoglycemia), you may have stomach pain, and diarrhea.

To avoid this unpleasant condition, **stay away from foods high in sugar.** A good rule of thumb is to avoid processed foods with more than 10 to 15 grams of sugar per serving. Remember, you can still eat whole fruits and dairy products, which have some natural sugars in them.



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Fats

Fats are important for your body, as they help you absorb essential vitamins that are fat-soluble—A, D, E, and K. They also provide some essential fatty acids (omega-3s and omega-6s) that your body cannot make on its own.

Fats have the most calories of all macronutrients at 9 calories per gram, so you need to watch your portions—even with the healthy ones.

Be careful with processed foods that say they are **fat-free or low fat**, as they often have more sugar or salt to make them taste better. Dairy products, like milk, yogurt, and cottage cheese, should be low-fat or nonfat to save on calories and saturated fats that can clog your arteries. Use these versions when you cook as much as possible.

Note that nonfat or 1 percent milk has the same amount of vitamins, minerals, and protein as whole milk. Choose full-fat foods from plant sources, like vegetable oils, nuts, seeds, avocados, olives, and fatty fish—all of which are good for your heart.

What to Eat: plant-based fats, such as avocados, canola oil, chia seeds, olive oil, nuts, and natural nut butters, and fish-based fats, such as fatty fish (salmon, mackerel, and tuna), and seafood



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Amount per Day: Very little at first; long term, no more than 30 percent of total calories from fats (mostly monounsaturated and polyunsaturated fats and less than 7 percent from saturated fats)

What to Limit: Butter, tropical oils (palm and coconut oil), full-fat dairy, and other vegetable oils
What to Avoid: animal fats (fat on meats, lard), fried foods, stick margarines with trans fats, and foods high in saturated fats

Vitamins, Minerals, and Supplements

The best way to get the nutrients your body needs after bariatric surgery is from food, but because you can only eat a small amount of food and some nutrients are not absorbed well, you need to take vitamin and mineral supplements after your surgery.

You need to take a multivitamin with minerals every day, no matter what kind of surgery you have.

The vitamins and minerals should be **100 to 200 percent of the daily recommended values**. You also need vitamin D, since most people who have the surgery are low in it.

Calcium is important for your bones, so you should take it too.

Iron may be needed, especially if you have the Roux-en-Y gastric bypass or BPD/DS, because these surgeries make it harder for your body to absorb iron.

Vitamin B12 is good for your nerves and blood, so you should take it as well. This is especially true if you have the Roux-en-Y gastric bypass or BPD/DS, and maybe if you have the sleeve gastrectomy.

Some vitamins that dissolve in fat may be needed if you have the BPD/DS. Talk to your team about this.

B-complex is another supplement that may help you. It has a lot of thiamine, which helps your metabolism. You may need this after any type of bariatric surgery. **Remember:** Taking these supplements is something you have to do for life.

I have seen people who stopped taking them after they reached their goal weight and got sick. Make sure to see your doctor regularly and check your blood levels of these nutrients.

